

Dillon Colbert

New York, NY • p: +1 (636) 295-2621 • e: dillon.colbert@nyu.edu • w: dilloncolbert.com

Urban data scientist and policy analyst modeling spatial data and regulatory mechanisms to rapidly mitigate climate change across the built and natural environments. Rooted in UN SDG11 and IPCC WGIII to reclaim autocentric uses for public space and active transport from the block-level up.

EDUCATION

New York University New York, NY
MS Urban Data Science – Center for Urban Science + Progress 05/2028

- Coursework: Transportation, Land Use, & Urban Form; Civic Analytics; Applied Data Science

Washington University St. Louis, MO
BS Environmental Engineering, Minor in Energy Engineering – Department of EECE 05/2025

- Coursework: Sustainable Cities, Metropolitan Development, Environmental Justice, IPCC Climate Policy
- 2025 Environmental Engineering Capstone: Competed at the WERC Environmental Design Contest on lithium carbonate recovery from treated brine to reduce waste and reuse for lithium ion-battery production
- 2023 International Experience (National University of Singapore): Attended lectures on renewables, carbon sequestration, water reclamation, etc., and toured industry facilities with cutting-edge engineering practices

EXPERIENCE

Streetsblog USA, NextSTL, Congress for the New Urbanism Remote
Freelance Writer – Urban Policy 02/2026 – Present

- Investigated how a Chicago to St. Louis success could anchor a national high-speed rail network with regional planning research and an interview with the director of the High Speed Rail Alliance (*Streetsblog*)
- Applied case studies on alleys and incremental development to argue for small business deregulation and the facilitation of entrepreneurial innovation ahead of St. Louis' 2026 Zoning Upgrade Plan (*NextSTL*)
- Expanded the *NextSTL* argument to the housing crisis, provoking conversation on street grid repair (*CNU*)

Citizens for Modern Transit St. Louis, MO
Transit Policy Intern 09/2025 – 12/2025

- Demonstrated transit-oriented development potential by tracking current vacancy and development costs for 100+ properties within a 0.5-mile buffer of future and historical Metro alignments (GIS, Excel)
- Translated light rail into bus rapid transit (BRT) terms in line with St. Louis' 2026-27 Board Bill 59 and Green Line project, primarily inspecting how to codify BRT elements like signal priority and dedicated lanes
- Collaborated with a variety of stakeholders (university administrators, government officials, financial institutions, corporate leadership) to inject public transit ideals into a broad range of conversations
- Cleaned 1000+ data entries and visualized results for public agency use (Excel Power Query [SQL], Adobe)

City of Ferguson Ferguson, MO
Sustainability Consultant 01/2025 – 05/2025

- Partnered with the City of Ferguson to build a public engagement framework, combining qualitative research and stakeholder interviews with web scraping (Apify, Excel) to evaluate community feedback
- Researched single-family zoning and municipal fragmentation to understand the institutional power levers and structural policy barriers enforcing spatial inequality in north St. Louis County

Midwest Climate Collaborative, WashU Office of Sustainability St. Louis, MO
Building Decarbonization Intern 05/2024 – 12/2024

- Managed data for 200 low-income, multifamily properties, aiming to lower CO₂ emissions by ≥20% after implementing energy-efficient measures like weatherization, low-flow faucets and showerheads, and lighting
- Assembled federal rebates from the Inflation-Reduction Act and Bipartisan Infrastructure Law, state Department of Natural Resources grants, and local utility incentives into a capital stack for property owners
- Attended ACEEE's 2024 Summer Study on Energy Efficiency in Buildings to network with representatives of the US National Laboratories, US Department of Energy, and leading research institutions

PROJECTS & LEADERSHIP

STL Urbanists, Strong Towns St. Louis

St. Louis, MO

Working Group and Conversation Leader

06/2025 – Present

- Moved the WashU bikeshare project to a formal STL Urbanists working group, collaborating with the City of St. Louis and regional mobility changemakers like Trailnet to interview for People for Bikes' national grant
- Planned and hosted a Downtown Park(ing) Day segment by canvassing 10+ businesses and collaborating with the Parking Reform Network, discussing parking reform and public realm activation with 4 city officials
- Developed mass-appealing rhetoric about the transportation and the built-environment in conversation with diverse audiences like the disabled community, real estate professionals, and faith-based communities

Sam Fox School of Design & Visual Arts, OSEP

Chouteau's Landing, St. Louis, MO

Community Design Researcher

03/2025 – 03/2026

- Qualitatively studied infrastructural barriers (highways, industrial sites, vacancy) using historical archives, photography, and street view to assess connectivity and produce 25 historical block comparisons (Adobe)
- Conducted multiple walking audits of the site itself and across the river in East St. Louis to paint the emotional condition of physical, infrastructure-related accessibility—observing sights, sounds, and smells

WashU Urbanists – Transportation & Mobility Club

St. Louis, MO

President

06/2024 – 05/2025

- Performed a walking audit with Forest Park Forever to evaluate the park's public interface with the university, collecting the park's demographic data and finding structural equity barriers to accessibility
- Advanced a campus bikeshare project to a citywide initiative through ~15 stakeholder meetings and survey data collection, presenting recommendations to the campus Mobility Task Force for funding
- During a 6-month presidency: filled 5 empty executive positions, added 40 members, raised average event attendance from 0-3 to 15-20, and increased the club's yearly base funding by >\$10,000
- Consistently strengthened partnerships with other university clubs and local nonprofits with 2-4 new weekly connections, significantly expanding project footprint, operational capacity, and innovation potential

Burning Kumquat

St. Louis, MO

Student Volunteer

06/2024 – 05/2025

- Worked in WashU's student garden to gain knowledge in native flora and building vertical planters, applying ideas of hyperlocal production and plans for the future of (urban) agriculture from a climate science course
- Won a \$500 grant from the university's Engineering Project Review Board to purchase gardening materials

SKILLS & AWARDS

Skills

- Analysis and Visualization: Python, R, MATLAB, ArcGIS Pro, Adobe Creative Suite, Microsoft Office
- Research Methods: Public Policy Analysis, Spatial & Statistical Analysis, Literature Review
- Writing: Policy Whitepapers, Advocacy Briefs, Editorials/Op-Eds, Interview Design, Technical Writing

Awards/Honors

- CUSP Rising Scholar | Honors in Innovation & Entrepreneurship | CityStudioSTL Fellowship